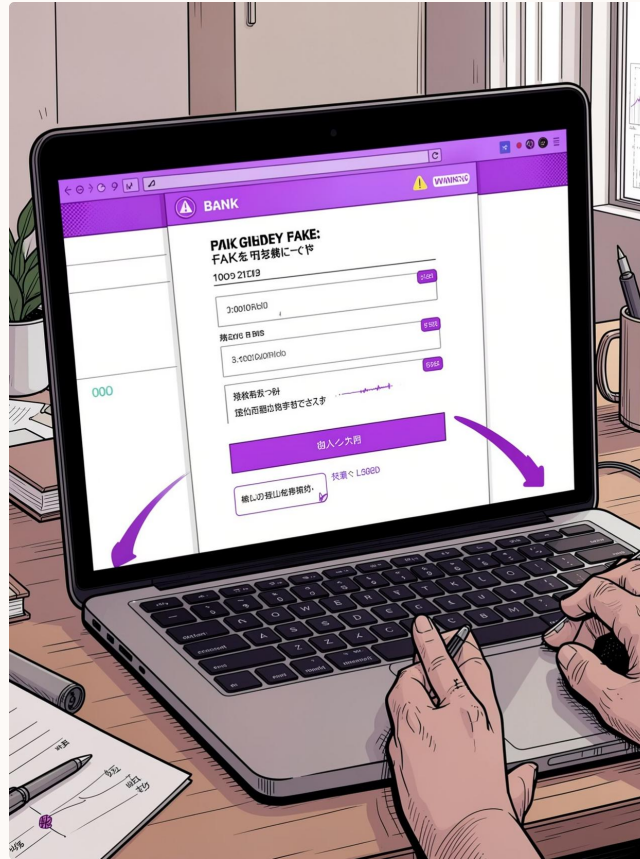




TASK 2: PhishingAwareness Training





The Anatomy of a Trap

What is phishing?

Digital bait-and-switch: attackers impersonate trusted senders to trick recipients into revealing sensitive data.

Attacker objectives

Steal passwords, credit card numbers, or gain unauthorized access to systems and accounts.

Core vulnerability

Phishing exploits human psychology—urgency, trust, curiosity—more than technical flaws.

The Spectrum of Deception



Standard Phishing

Mass-distributed, low-effort emails pretending to be banks, services, or deliveries.



Spear Phishing

Highly personalized, leverages public info (LinkedIn, socials) to increase credibility.



Clone Phishing

A real email is copied and re-sent with malicious links or attachments swapped in.

The "Red Flag" Checklist

→ Urgency & Threats

Language demanding immediate action or threatening account suspension—pause and verify.

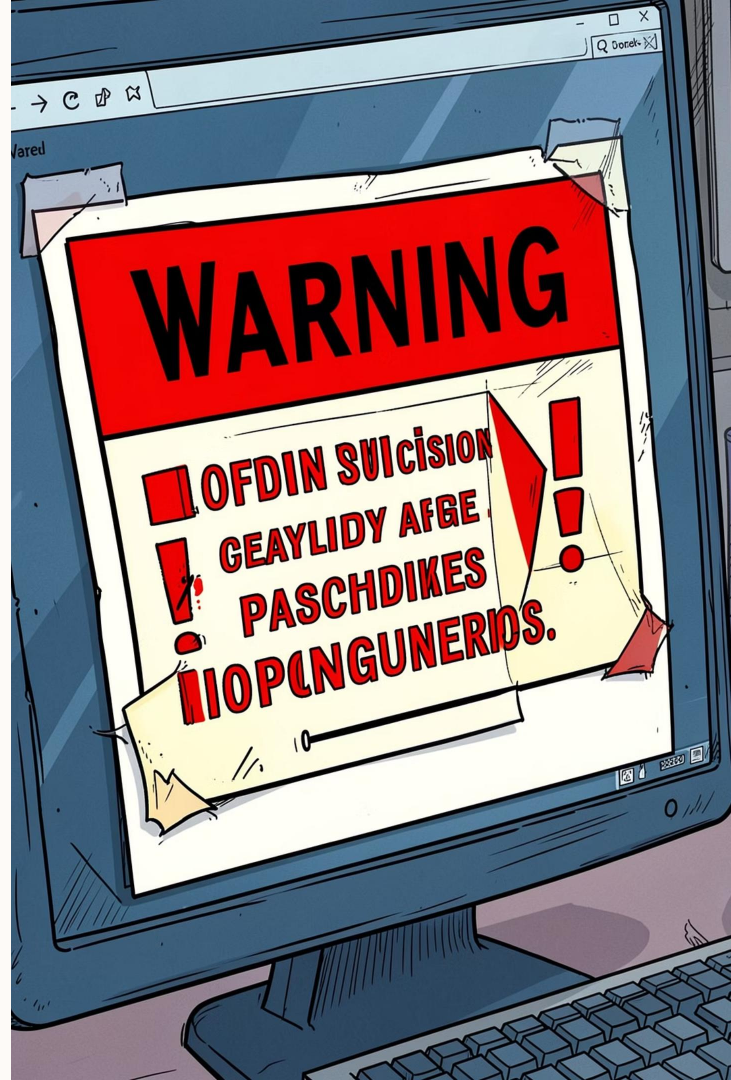
→ Sender Inconsistencies

Mismatch between display name and email domain; look for slight domain alterations.

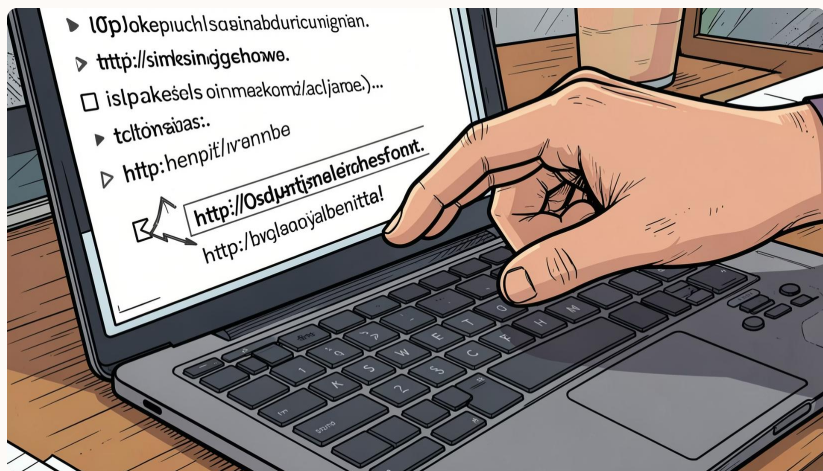
→ Poor Grammar & Formatting

Typos, awkward phrasing, odd signatures, or incorrect logos often indicate fraud.

📄 Theme color: #6237C8 — treat flagged items with extra suspicion.



Investigating the Digital Footprint



Quick checks before you click

- The Hover Test: Reveal the actual URL (don't trust link text).
- Domain integrity: Watch for substitutions like '0' for 'o', extra words, or different TLDs.
- Security indicators: Look for HTTPS and the lock icon — but remember HTTPS alone isn't a proof of legitimacy.

Anatomy of a Fake Website

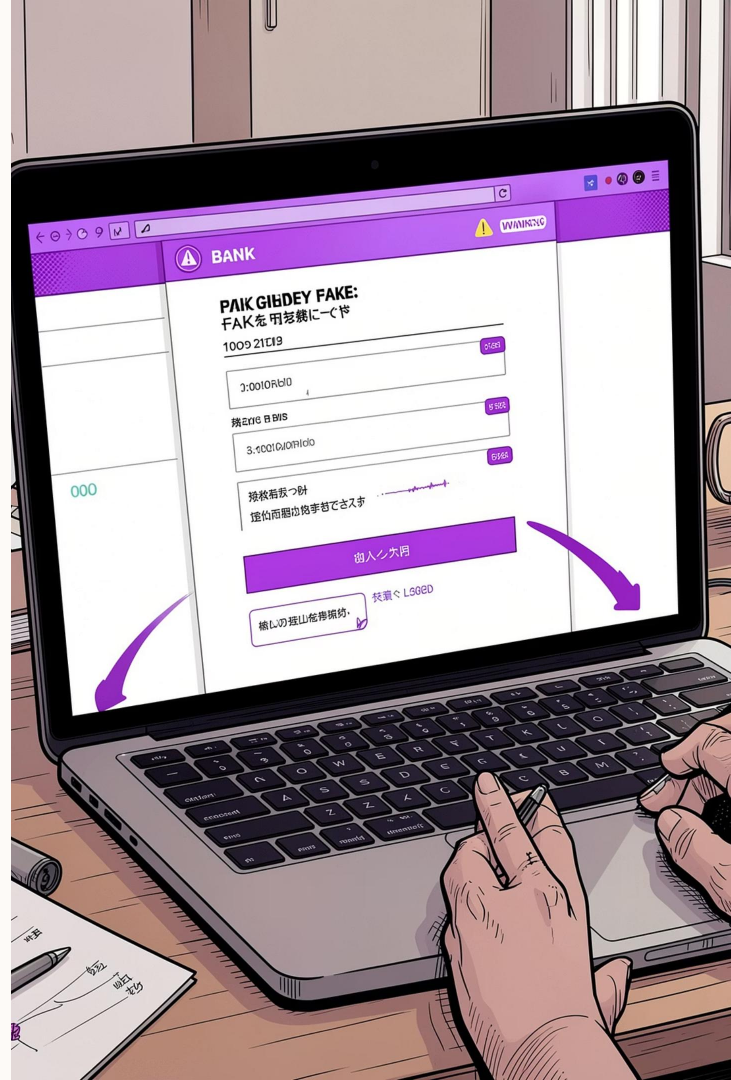
Attackers create pixel-perfect pages that mimic trusted services. When credentials are entered, data is harvested immediately. Modern browsers provide warnings—keep them and your OS updated.

What to look for

Unusual subdomains, login forms on unexpected pages, mismatched branding, and newly registered domains.

Mitigations

Manually type known URLs, use bookmarks, and enable browser phishing protections and extensions.



Social Engineering Tactics

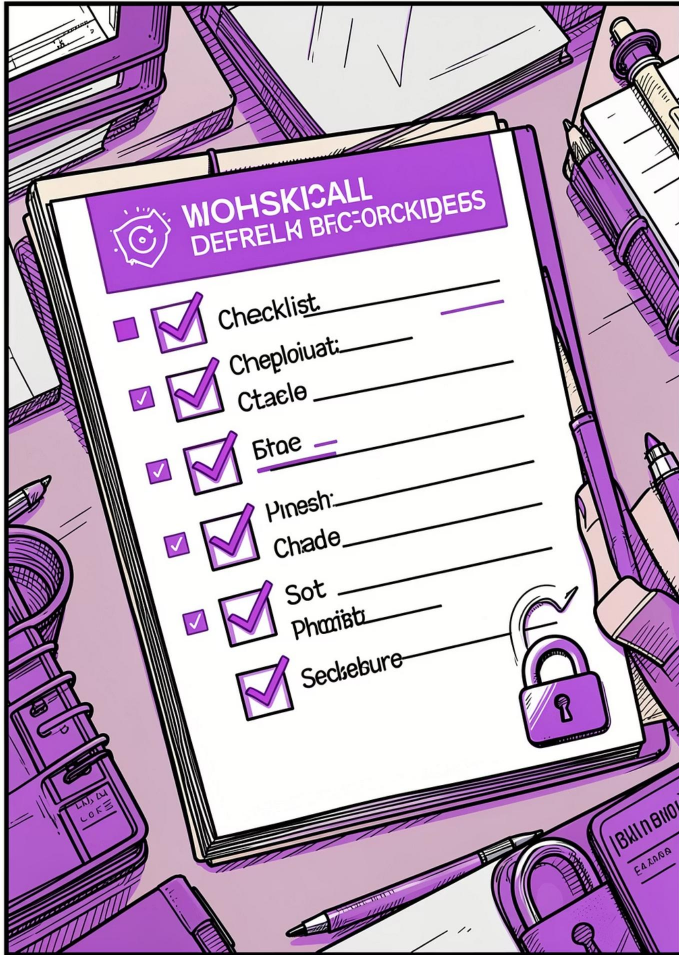


Attackers manipulate emotions and context. Common tactics:

- Pretexting: Inventing believable stories (IT support, HR requests).
- Authority & urgency: Posing as executives to bypass checks.
- Reciprocity & curiosity: Fake rewards, unexpected attachments, or urgent requests for help.

 If someone pressures you to bypass policy—stop, validate, and escalate.

Best Practices & Defensive Habits



Verify Before Acting

Never use links or phone numbers provided in suspicious messages; use official sites or known contacts.

Use Strong Authentication

Enable MFA (prefer hardware or authenticator apps) to reduce damage if credentials leak.

Report & Remove

Report suspected phishing to IT, mark messages as spam, and delete suspicious emails.



Tip: Bookmark critical services and always access them from bookmarks, not email links.

Case Study: The "Urgent" Account Breach

Scenario: You receive an urgent email threatening account deletion within 24 hours.

01

Step 1 — Pause & Inspect

Hover links, check sender domain, and scan for grammar or brand errors.

03

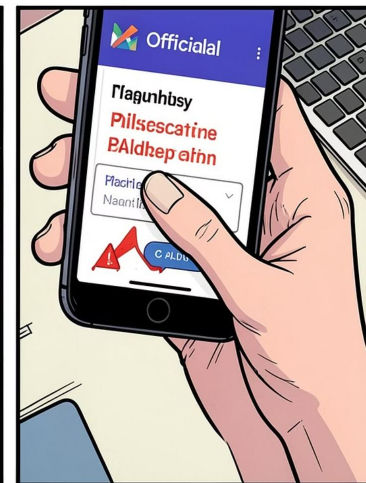
Step 3 — Report

If fraudulent, forward to IT/security and delete the message. If safe, note what made it suspicious.

02

Step 2 — Verify Independently

Open the official app or bookmarked site, or call a known support number to confirm.



Interactive Quiz & Next Steps

Practice makes protection. Try these quick scenarios:

1. An email asks you to reset a password via a link — what do you do?
2. You get an invoice from a known vendor with an unexpected attachment — how do you verify?
3. A colleague messages asking for an urgent transfer — what steps confirm legitimacy?

Suggested answers & actions:

- Open the official site from a bookmark or type the URL; do not click the email link.
- Contact the vendor via a known phone or portal; scan attachments in a sandbox.
- Call the colleague using a verified number and confirm with their manager for high-risk requests.

 Commitment: Verify, pause, and protect. Share this guide and report suspected phishing immediately.

Stay vigilant — your skepticism is the strongest layer of defense.